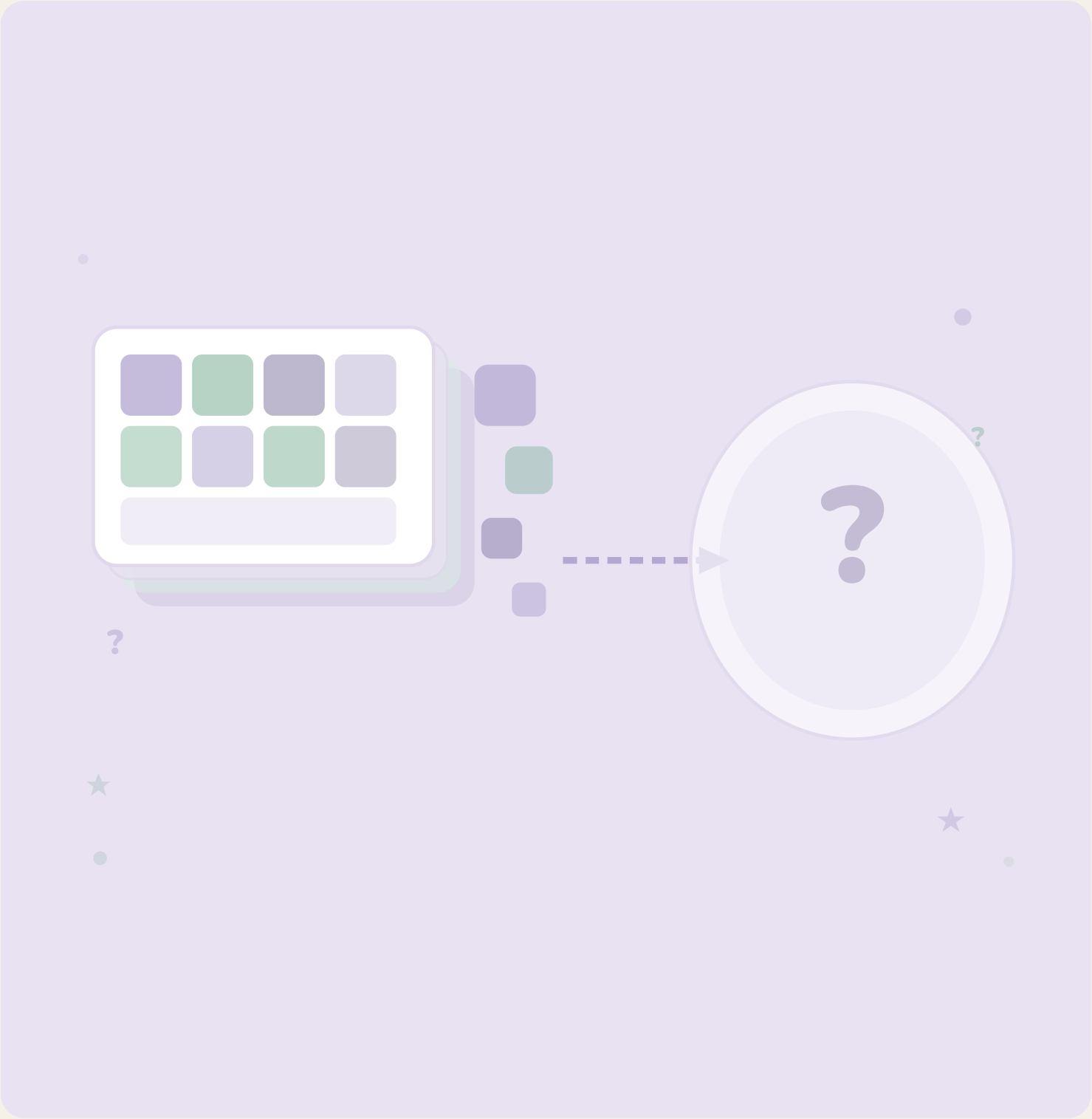
HOW DOES AI LEARN?

How did AI learn to do all this?



OBSERVE

PATTERN

TEST

HOW DOES AI LEARN?

AI learns from examples — lots of them. This card uses a simple cat vs dog sorting game to show how training data shapes what AI can and cannot recognise, and why limited examples lead to limited understanding.

MAIN ACTIVITY

1. Show 10 cat pictures, one at a time. Tell the class: "You are the AI. Learn what a cat looks like."
2. Show 10 dog pictures. Same instruction for dog.
3. Now show new, tricky pictures (a black cat after only white cats, a small dog that looks like a cat, etc.). Students vote: cat or dog?
4. Ask: "If I had only shown you white cats, would you recognise a black cat?"

MATERIALS

- 10 cat pictures and 10 dog pictures (printed or projected)
- 5–6 tricky "test" pictures

REFLECTION

- What clues helped you decide?
- What made some pictures hard?
- If AI only saw a few examples, what would it get wrong?

REALITY CHECK

AI learns from examples — millions of them.

The more varied the examples, the better AI gets at recognising new things. AI does not understand cats like you do; it learns which patterns usually come with the word "cat".

DIGITAL GAME

Training Game — Teach the AI

Scan to play →